

Sudanese Hibiscus

الكردييه السوداني

Hibiscus sabdariffa

Dried calyces, sun-dried

***Hibiscus sabdariffa* L.**

Botanical source

Kordofan and Darfur

Origin

1211.90

HS code (indicative)

1 Scope

This sheet specifies dried hibiscus calyces for human consumption, as exported by Asmagh Sudanese Exports from Port Sudan.

2 Synonyms

Roselle

Karkade

Red sorrel

Flor de Jamaica

3 Definition

The dried calyx, with its epicalyx, of *Hibiscus sabdariffa* L. (family Malvaceae), collected during fruiting. The calyx is the fleshy, cup-shaped part that surrounds the seed capsule.

4 Description

Deep red, fleshy calyces grown mainly in Kordofan and Darfur and dried in the sun after harvest. They give a bright red infusion with a sour taste.

5 Product categories



Whole calyx

The complete calyx, as picked from the plant, dried and cleaned.



Loose sepals

Whole sepals separated from the calyx.



Siftings (nekhala)

A mixture of whole calyces and sepal pieces separated during cleaning.



Broken

Calyces broken or ground mechanically during primary processing.

Available as

Whole

Cut for tea bags

Powder

6 Commercial grades

Minimum share of whole calyces or sepals, and maximum impurities, by grade. Impurities are parts of the plant other than the calyx.

Category	Grade 1	Grade 2	Grade 3	Grade 4
Whole calyx	≥ 95 % complete calyces impurities ≤ 1 %	≥ 80 % complete calyces impurities ≤ 2 %	≥ 65 % complete calyces impurities ≤ 3 %	≥ 50 % complete calyces impurities ≤ 3 %
Loose sepals	≥ 90 % complete sepals impurities ≤ 3 %	≥ 80 % complete sepals impurities ≤ 3 %	≥ 70 % complete sepals impurities ≤ 4 %	≥ 50 % complete sepals impurities ≤ 4 %
Siftings (nekhala)	≥ 40 % complete sepals impurities ≤ 4 %	≥ 30 % complete sepals impurities ≤ 4 %	≥ 20 % complete sepals impurities ≤ 5 %	≥ 20 % complete sepals impurities ≤ 5 %
Broken	Completely free from dirt and other foreign matter; packed in sealed packages that keep out dust and moisture.			

7 Uses



Tea and herbal infusions



Drinks and syrup concentrates



Natural food colouring

8 Requirements

8.1 General requirements

- ✓ Free from hibiscus seeds
- ✓ Cleaned and free from foreign objects, impurities and dust
- ✓ Free from insects, harmful microbial contamination, pesticide residues and other harmful material
- ✓ Heavy metals within the Codex General Standard for Contaminants and Toxins in Food and Feed (CXS 193-1995)
- ✓ Radioactivity within the limits of the importing country
- ✓ Best used within 2 years from the date of production

8.2 Technical requirements



Moisture
≤ 10 %

AOAC

Cold-water extract
≥ 35 %

AOAC

Hot-water extract
≥ 40 %

AOAC

Dust
≤ 3 %

AOAC

Total ash
≤ 10 %

AOAC

Acidity, pH of infusion
≤ 3.5

AOAC

Percent by mass, except pH. Tested by AOAC methods.

8.3 For pharmaceutical and herbal-tea buyers

The European Pharmacopoeia monograph *Roselle* (*Hibisci sabdariffae flos*) sets, among other tests:

Foreign matter	≤ 2 %	Loss on drying	≤ 11 %
Total ash	≤ 10 %	Acidity, as citric acid	≥ 13.5 % (dried drug)
Colouring intensity	≥ 0.350 whole; ≥ 0.250 cut		

Values as published in Ph. Eur. 7.0; check the current edition. Ask us for lot results against these tests before contracting.

9 Storage and transport

Store and transport in ways that protect the calyces from damage and spoilage: clean, dry and cool, away from strong odours.

10 Packaging

New, clean packages that do not change the product's properties or nutritional value, made of materials safe for food. Asmagh ships in new polypropylene bags of 20-25 kg.

Container load about 5-6 MT per 20 ft container.



11 Labelling

Every package carries a clear, durable label, in line with Sudanese Standard SDS 099/2002, showing:

Product name	Product type and grade	Date of production	Code
 Dried hibiscus	 e.g. whole calyx, grade 1	 Month and year	 Lot code
Country of origin	Place of processing	Brand name	Net weight (kg)
 Sudan	 Sudan	 Asmagh Sudanese Exports	 20 or 25 kg

12 Shelf life

Best used within 2 years from the date of production.

13 Sampling and testing

Tests follow AOAC methods. Each shipment carries an analysis and quality certificate issued by the Sudanese Standards & Metrology Organization (SSMO). Buyers may appoint an international inspection company to sample at loading.

From farm to port

من المزرعة إلى الميناء

Every lot is sampled on arrival, cleaned, graded and tested before it is packed. Storage and loading are checked too, because quality can be lost after processing.

1 Our quality process

1



Sourcing

Bought from trusted growers and traders in Kordofan and Darfur; every incoming lot is checked.

2



Cleaning

Seeds, stems, sand and dust removed by hand and machine.

3



Grading

Sorted into whole calyx, loose sepals and siftings, grades 1 to 4.

4



Cutting and milling

Cut to tea-bag size or milled into powder when ordered.

5



Testing

Samples tested for moisture, impurities and the parameters in the buyer's specification.

6



Packing

Packed in new polypropylene bags marked with product, grade, lot and weight.

7



Storage

Kept dry and ventilated, off the floor and away from contamination until loading.

8



Loading and shipping

Containers inspected and loading supervised; shipped from Port Sudan with full documents.

2 Origin and shipping

Sudanese hibiscus is grown mainly in Kordofan and Darfur and dried in the sun after harvest. Its dark red calyces are among the most sought-after in the world. They travel to Port Sudan on the Red Sea for export.

HS code	1211.90 (indicative; confirm with your customs broker)
Port of loading	Port Sudan (SDPZU), Red Sea
Container load	About 5–6 MT per 20 ft container
Ready to load	Usually 10–15 days after contract
Transit	About 2–8 weeks, by destination
Delivery terms	FOB Port Sudan, CFR or CIF
Payment terms	Irrevocable L/C at sight, TT advance, or D/P
Samples	Free; courier paid by the buyer

3 Export documents

Certificates travel with each shipment and are exchanged through the banks or directly with the buyer, so the goods clear customs at destination.

Product certificates



Certificate of origin
Sudan Chamber of Commerce; general or preferential forms.



Phytosanitary certificate
Official inspection against the importing country's pest list.



Analysis and quality certificate
Issued by the Sudanese Standards & Metrology Organization (SSMO).



Fumigation certificate
Treatment, chemical, dose and temperature used.



Inspection certificate
Optional; by an international inspection company chosen by the buyer.

Shipping documents



Export contract
Attested by the Ministry of Trade and the Chamber of Commerce.



Commercial invoice
Goods, quantity, value and terms.



Packing list
Every bag in each container, with counts and weights.



Bill of lading
Issued by the shipping line on loading.

4 Standards and references

- Codex Alimentarius. General Standard for Contaminants and Toxins in Food and Feed, CXS 193-1995.
- AOAC International. Official Methods of Analysis.
- European Pharmacopoeia, monograph *Roselle* (Hibisci sabdariffae flos), Ph. Eur. 7.0 (2008). EDQM, Council of Europe.
- Sudanese Standards & Metrology Organization (SSMO). SDS 099/2002, labelling.

